or topics from the more recent period. This limitation could be mitigated by expanding DELPHI to additional data sources.

Volume. We only annotated 29k of the 474k data available, and arguably only 24k of the 73k “more likely to be controversial” questions. This limitation could be resolved by setting up subsequent annotation projects given a continued interested from the community on such dataset.

Expiration. Since the controversy is a reflection of the Zeitgeist, the very concept of controversial would foreseeable evolve with time. Such changes and pace of change may vary for every topic or question, and may required a periodical review of the label validity. This limitation could be mitigated by setting up an expiration date on all ground-truth controversy labels, and maintaining a history of human annotation input for the same dataset.

Use of LLMs

We used LLMs for following purposes, as stated in the main text of this paper: (1) pre-labeling of the dataset to enable efficient annotation; (3) pre-filtering for harmful content to safeguard human annotator welfare; (4) candidate models for evaluation to understand how they handle controversial questions; (5) automated evaluation of LLMs’ responses. In addition, we used LLMs to: (a) grammar check and/or polish part of the text in the Abstract and Introduction section, (b) help conceive a title that yields the intended acronym, "DELPHI".

Ethics Statement

This paper honors the ACL Code of Ethics. With regard to the annotation project described in the paper, we clarify that following the best practices laid out in Kirk et al. (2022) and Vidgen and Derczynski (2020), participation in the project was voluntary, with an opt-out option and an alternative project available to annotators at all times. Annotators were additionally able to skip any specific utterance they might be uncomfortable with. The annotation guidelines explicitly explained the potential harm of reading prompts that express bias and stereotypical opinions. Moreover, no explicitly toxic or harmful language was included in the project.

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